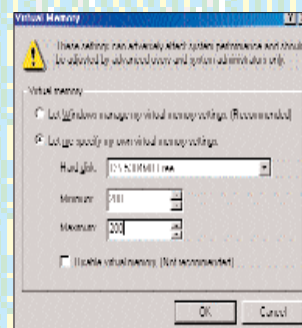


The screenshot shows the 'System Configuration Utility' window with the 'Services' tab selected. The 'Startup' column is checked, and the 'System Restore' service is highlighted. The 'Startup' column is checked, indicating it is set to start at boot. The 'System Restore' service is set to 'Automatic'.

■ Clicking the Startup tab will bring up some more interesting startup options. Here, one can manually select which programs must load during Windows startup and which ones must not. Disable those applications that you don't use on a daily basis. This will help you save precious

Defragmenting your hard disk fixes up links and positions files so they are quicker to access. Run the Disk Defragmenter at least once a month to keep your computer in good shape. Click **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools** and click on 'Disk Defragmenter' to set about this task.

When system memory runs short, Windows uses the available hard disk space as virtual memory. It's a lot slower than actual RAM but at the same time, it is necessary. If you have a surplus of RAM in the region of 512 MB or more,



you can disable the swap file altogether, thereby boosting system performance. To do this, go to **Control Panel > System**. Click on the 'Performance' tab and select 'Virtual Memory'. Click the radio box that lets you specify your own settings and subsequently check the box next to 'Disable virtual memory'.

The other route is to fix upon a swap file size so that Windows doesn't waste any time resizing it. Click **Control Panel > System** and go to the 'Performance' tab. Click the 'Virtual Memory' button and select the option that lets you specify your own settings. For an average computer with 128 MB RAM, keep the minimum and maximum size to approximately 200 MB—any more would be a waste of free hard disk space.



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